Aoife Brannigan

Staff Engineer, Data APIs

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SUMMARY

Staff engineer with fifteen years across analytics products and public APIs. I specialise in query-heavy Python backends, schema evolution and keeping systems understandable after the original authors leave. I write long design documents, short commit messages and, occasionally, a conference talk about avoiding accidental complexity. I mentor, review and write documentation.

SKILLS

Python, Django, Pandas, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, Airflow, GraphQL (Graphene), pytest, Hypothesis, API design, Technical writing, dbt, Sphinx

EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer, Corrib Analytics 2018 – Present

- Own the reporting API that serves 900 enterprise tenants; designed tenant-aware query planning that cut cost per request by 45%.
- Defined the API deprecation policy and versioning strategy, adopted across eleven teams.
- Services run on the company's Kubernetes platform; I rely on the platform team for deployments and keep my focus on application code.
- Coached eight engineers through promotion cycles.
- Present quarterly at a regional Python conference on query planning and data modelling.

Senior Developer, Shannon Data Labs 2013 – 2018

- Built a Django application for geospatial datasets with 50 million records.
- Introduced property-based testing using Hypothesis, finding three long-standing rounding defects.
- Replaced cron scripts with Airflow DAGs and alerting.
- Raised the unit test count from 400 to over 3,000 with strict review rules for new code.
- Mentored three junior engineers on database design and testing.

Developer, Lough Systems 2009 – 2013

- Wrote Python and SQL for a utilities billing system.
- Created data migration tooling used in five customer rollouts.
- Introduced code review and a simple release checklist to a small team.
- Received the company's customer-impact award in 2012.
- Wrote a public guide on designing paginated APIs that is still used for onboarding new engineers.

EDUCATION

- BSc Applied Mathematics and Computing, University of Western Ireland (2005 – 2009)

LANGUAGES

English (native), Irish (B2)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Advanced PostgreSQL Practitioner, Atlantic Database Guild

- Technical Leadership Programme, Galway Management School